

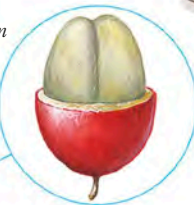


A coffee tree produces about 2,000 fruits each year. It takes twice this amount to make two pounds (one kilogram) of roasted coffee.

The fruits are called cherries because of their color and size.

The coffee is harvested twice a year.

There are two green coffee beans inside each cherry. They only turn brown after they are roasted.



The trees are pruned to stop them from growing more than 10 feet (three meters) high.

When the fruits first appear, they are green. Gradually, they turn bright red. They are then ready to be picked.



The ripe fruit is picked by hand or shaken from the tree onto a cloth spread out underneath it. On some plantations, machines are used to pick the fruit.

Heavy load

Cocoa pods are large and heavy. They grow on the trunk of the cacao tree or from its thick branches.

The pod has a thick skin.

Each pod may contain 20 to 50 cocoa beans.

The pod grows up to 12 inches (30 cm) long, about the size of a football.

